

PETER SMYER JR

Senior Instructional Designer | Learning Solutions Architect

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SUMMARY

Instructional designer with nine years in learning and development, building end to end from needs analysis through design, build, facilitation and iteration. Owns training enablement for four outsourced vendor partners across three countries and five lines of business, certifying external facilitators to deliver independently. Administers LearnUpon, the LMS — platform configuration, user management and learning-path architecture — and authors in Articulate Rise 360. Deep domain specialisation in marketplace lending and consumer credit, including regulated training that produces tracked completion evidence.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Instructional Design: ADDIE · Bloom's Taxonomy · Kirkpatrick evaluation · Thalheimer LTEM · needs analysis · curriculum architecture · assessment design · storyboarding · adult learning theory · cognitive load · retrieval practice

Authoring & Media: Articulate Rise 360 · Articulate Storyline 360 · Camtasia · Adobe Creative Suite · Adobe Premiere · Canva · video production and editing

Platforms & Analytics: LearnUpon (administration) · Confluence · LMS configuration · learning analytics · assessment analytics · engagement reporting · Reach 360 (prior)

Facilitation & Enablement: train-the-trainer · facilitator certification · vendor training enablement · multi-site calibration · QA/QC alignment · instructor coaching · live and virtual facilitation · new-hire onboarding · blended learning

Program & Governance: change management · training impact assessment · vendor partner management · regulated and compliance training · stakeholder alignment · knowledge management

Domain: marketplace lending · peer-to-peer lending · investor services · consumer credit and credit card · collections · escalations · fraud · regulated financial services

Applied AI: AI-assisted instructional design · prompt engineering · research synthesis · evidence-based design · interactive prototype development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Instructional Designer / LXD | Prosper Marketplace

Remote | May 2022 – Present (Instructional Designer 2022–2025; promoted to Senior 2026)

- Owns the training relationship with four outsourced vendor partners across three countries — Canada, the United States and El Salvador — covering five lines of business and six external facilitators. Sets and runs the meeting cadence with each partner, drives follow-ups to closure and delegates work across facilitators, vendor managers and QA/QC.
- Certifies external facilitators to deliver independently, including re-certification after vendor turnover and participation in the hiring loop for the replacement.
- Delivered three concurrent training launches in a single week (August 2026) — a Personal Loan Collections new-hire class for the Buffalo, NY partner, a new El Salvador partner launched from a standing start, and internal foundations training for the fraud team facilitated personally — while managing learner enrollment across all three.
- Built the full curriculum for the El Salvador partner launch — foundations and role-specific — and runs the partnership remotely through their in-house facilitator.
- Administers LearnUpon, the LMS — platform configuration, user and group management, and learning-path structure — and runs learner enrollment across concurrent vendor and internal cohorts.
- Designed and built 50+ eLearning programs end to end using Articulate Rise 360, Storyline 360, Camtasia and Adobe Creative Suite.
- Redesigned new-hire onboarding, cutting time to proficiency 40% — measured as days from start date to nesting graduation and first unassisted case work.
- Drove a 30% engagement lift through instructional redesign, and a further 50% after redesigning assessments — measured on course completion, module progression and post-course feedback.
- Builds regulated training that produces tracked completion evidence across consumer lending, collections and fraud, delivered through internal teams and outsourced partners in three countries.
- Serves as the senior instructional design voice in the change management process, assessing the training impact of product and policy changes before release.

Operations Support Specialist (Training) | Western State Bank

Phoenix, AZ | December 2020 – December 2021

- Built and facilitated the bank's entire teller training program — curriculum, materials and delivery — for a function that had no formal training.
- Developed the bank's home equity lending training from the ground up.
- Introduced blended learning and interactive content to new-employee onboarding, replacing shadow-only training.
- Identified capability gaps from learner feedback and performance data, then built targeted eLearning against them.

Senior Team Lead / Team Lead / Investor Services | Prosper Marketplace

Phoenix, AZ | October 2016 – December 2020

- Built the Investor Services team's first training resource (2017) — captured undocumented team knowledge into a structured Confluence knowledge base where no formal training existed.
- Served as interim HELOC trainer (2019–2020) alongside team leadership, building and delivering home equity lending curriculum; earned NMLS Mortgage Loan Originator licensure to support that delivery.
- Promoted to Team Lead (2018), then Senior Team Lead (2020) — led customer service delivery through the onset of the pandemic.
- Worked both sides of the marketplace — borrower and investor, with primary depth on the investor side — plus ongoing work across the consumer credit card product.

Small Business Consultant | GoDaddy

Phoenix, AZ | August 2014 – June 2016

- Ran the full consultative cycle — discovery, solution design and implementation — advising small business owners on digital presence, product fit and growth.

INDEPENDENT & ADDITIONAL WORK

Founder & Operator — The Modern Conquest | Independent

Remote | 2026 – Present · domain held since 2016

- Founded and operate a cultural heritage brand end to end — content strategy, production, brand identity and storefront.
- Built a complete brand identity system — original mark with three lockups, a defined two-tone logo rule, a six-colour palette and three documented visual style modes with consistency rules. Scale-tested, with a documented variant rule for small sizes.
- Produce visual content at publication cadence across Instagram and TikTok, with captions and short-form video scripts written to defined per-channel voice modes.
- Operate a live print-on-demand storefront, developing products from measured top-performing content rather than generic concepts, and feeding performance data back into what gets produced next.
- Authored the brand's content governance rules — claim accuracy, attribution of source material, and explicit editorial boundaries.

Applied AI & Evidence-Based Learning Design | Self-directed

2026 – Present

- Designed and published an interactive simulation-based assessment teaching reviewers to catch defective AI-drafted communications in a regulated context — misconception-first sequencing, mastery-rubric scoring, no points or badges. Single HTML file, no dependencies, runs offline. Design rationale published alongside it with effect-size citations.
- Synthesised nineteen deep research passes on adult learning science, then designed curriculum against measured effect sizes — selecting simulation-based assessment (knowledge $d = 1.20$, transfer $d = 0.82$) and auditing gamification mechanics to exclude those with no measurable learning effect.
- Applied Kirkpatrick and Thalheimer's LTEM to design measurement in environments with no LMS.

Training materials — municipal services operator | Winslow, AZ

Independent contribution

- Built training materials used by a distributed, non-desk field workforce at a company operating under a municipal services contract — a delivery context with none of the assumptions corporate eLearning is built on.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Bachelor of Arts, Film & Video Editing — Collins College, 2014

E-Learning Instructional Design Certificate — Association for Talent Development (ATD), December 2022

NMLS Mortgage Loan Originator — 2019–2022. Retained regulatory literacy in consumer lending compliance (TILA, RESPA, ECOA).